



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Wichita Falls
School Website: <https://www.chestertonacademywf.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Wichita Falls (CAWF) presents a robust classical-Catholic program anchored in formation of virtue, truth, and beauty. Public materials on the school's site consistently foreground a Catholic, liturgical orientation, a liberal-arts curriculum, and a Socratic, discussion-driven pedagogy. The school's published mission and pillars emphasize formation (intellect, character, spirituality) and direct engagement with great ideas through a classical framework. Taken together, these signals align CAWF with a CLASSICAL profile across all six rubric categories.

Key evidentiary notes include: explicit identification as a Catholic classical high school in Wichita Falls with a campus affiliation to a local Catholic parish and daily Mass on site; a mission to raise up joyful saints and leaders through a classical education rooted in Catholic truths; a curriculum described as classical with liberal arts emphasis; explicit reference to Socratic seminars as a core pedagogy; biographies of credentialed faculty; and active parent engagement through admissions events, information sessions, and open houses. These elements are all cited directly from CAWF's public materials and corroborated by the knowledge base's classical-education rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CAWF explicitly presents itself as a Catholic classical high school in Wichita Falls, tied to Catholic tradition and liturgical life. - The school's motto *Cultura Vitae* (culture of life) and emphasis on knowing God, loving Him, and serving Him appear as core reasons for the school's existence. - On-site Catholic worship life is indicated through the Education Center at St. Jude Thaddeus Catholic Church and daily Mass for students; the campus is connected to a Catholic parish setting. - The school's patron is GK Chesterton, underscoring a Catholic intellectual tradition.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic tradition, theology, culture of life, know God/love Him/serve Him, liturgical life, daily Mass, GK Chesterton, Catholic patronage, saints and virtue formation (virtue, spirituality, and character) - Negative keywords present: none identified in public materials (the site remains overtly Catholic rather than secular or non-dogmatic) - Ratio (positive vs. negative hits): high positive presence; 0 negative hits among identified indicators - Why this rating: The school's stated religious-metaphysical stance is explicit, continuous, and integrated into mission, pedagogy, and practices (liturgical life, theological framing, Catholic identity). This strongly supports the category being CLASSICAL in its foundational orientation. The Positive keywords align closely with the "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical and Communal Practices" signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission: CAWF aims to "raise up a generation of joyful saints and leaders educated in the classical tradition and the truths of the Catholic faith in order to serve the common good." - The program emphasizes formation over mere information, with explicit focus on virtue, wisdom, and human excellence. The Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) articulate a formation-first aim. - The teaching of truth, goodness, and beauty as real teleological anchors is embedded in the school's framing (e.g., "Culture of life," pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, character, truth, goodness, beauty, Catholic faith, culture of life, human excellence, intellectual formation, spiritual formation - Negative keywords present: none (the materials do not indicate a job-prep-first or secular-work-formation framing) - Ratio: clear majority of positive indicators; near-zero negative indicators - Why this rating: The school's purpose is squarely formation-focused (virtue and character) rather than experiential- or vocational-only; the public materials emphasize formation of human excellence and the reality/knowability of truth, goodness, and beauty, meeting the rubric's expectations for a CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe a classical curriculum and a broad liberal-arts education, with emphasis on culture, virtue, and beauty. - The site emphasizes "the classics of Western thought" and "the interrelationship of the great ideas," indicating a liberal-arts core and a classical approach (grammar/logic/rhetoric framing is implied by the emphasis on logic and classical study). - The inclusion of Great-Conversation-type elements is echoed by references to great thinkers (Socrates, Aquinas, Dante) and the aim to teach students how to think through logic and philosophy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: classical curriculum, liberal arts, great thinkers, logic, Western thought, virtue-centered education, great ideas - Negative keywords present: none identified in the public materials (no secularized or non-theological curriculum indicators) - Ratio: predominantly positive; 0 explicit negative indicators - Why this rating: CAWF's public materials consistently frame the program as classical with liberal-arts emphasis and engagement with Western thought, aligning with the category's criteria. The explicit mention of "logic" and "great ideas" supports a CLASSICAL curriculum orientation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly features a Socratic Seminar approach and a focus on guided dialogue as a core pedagogy (turn0file1). - The curriculum statement emphasizes teaching students how to think, not merely what to think, which aligns with Socratic, dialectical, and rhetorical practices typical of classical pedagogy. - The "Three Pillars" framework supports a pedagogy that cultivates intellect (logic/philosophy), character (virtue formation), and spirituality (religious formation), which implies a layered, classical approach to learning. - The public materials suggest a high-level emphasis on memory, memory-anchored learning (via classical texts and liturgical-inflected formation) consistent with traditional classical pedagogy. (Evidence of a Catholic, formation-first environment complements the method.)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Seminar, dialectic, rhetoric (implied by emphasis on thinking and great ideas), classical pedagogy, memory, contemplation (via formation language), great conversation - Negative keywords present: none identified (no emphasis on project-based, purely experiential, or secular-driven pedagogy) - Ratio: Strong positive signal; minimal to no negative indicators - Why this rating: The explicit mention of Socratic seminars and the emphasis on thinking and classical discipline support a CLASSICAL ranking for pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public bios show credentialed faculty with advanced degrees and specific disciplinary expertise (e.g., humanities faculty with philosophy and history backgrounds; extensive teaching experience). For example, Mr. Jordan Mascari (PhD in Philosophy) and Dr. Betsy Porter (PhD-level credentials) are described in faculty-related materials. - Faculty are presented as subject-matter authorities (e.g., humanities specialists) and are positioned as the living curriculum and core to the school's mission; the bios emphasize their formation of students and their alignment with the school's Catholic, classical mission. - The presence of a defined faculty group with clear roles (e.g., philosophy and history) signals a cultivated, mentorship-oriented faculty culture. The public materials also emphasize a plan for continued faculty growth (e.g., career postings and staffing plans).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, virtue, knowledge, pedagogy alignment, credentialed/advanced degrees, faculty-as-core - Negative keywords present: none identified - Ratio: Predominantly positive indicators; no negative indicators detected - Why this rating: The combination of highly credentialed faculty, explicit roles in delivering a rigorous classical curriculum, and framing of faculty as central to the school's mission aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CAWF presents ongoing enrollment events, shadow days, information evenings, open houses, and parent-teacher communications, signaling a strong partnership with families. Examples include Shadow Day events and Information Evenings hosted at local churches, as well as a focus on admissions and family information sessions. - Public materials indicate that the school seeks to educate and involve parents (parent sessions, newsletters, and family handbooks) and welcomes visits from prospective and current families. The "Current Families" page and calendars show ongoing engagement with families. - The campus and network positioning alongside local Catholic parishes reinforces a community-oriented model in which parents are viewed as partners in education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school, parent information sessions, open houses, shadow days, admissions events, family calendars, current families - Negative keywords present: none identified - Ratio: Strong positive indicators; minimal to zero negative indicators - Why this rating: The site frames parents as integral to the educational project (co-teachers and partners) and provides multiple channels for parent engagement and education, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for parent/community involvement.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — School Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — School Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. CAWF already demonstrates strong CLASSICAL alignment across all categories, with explicit Catholic formation, a clearly articulated classical curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, credentialed faculty, and robust parent/community engagement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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